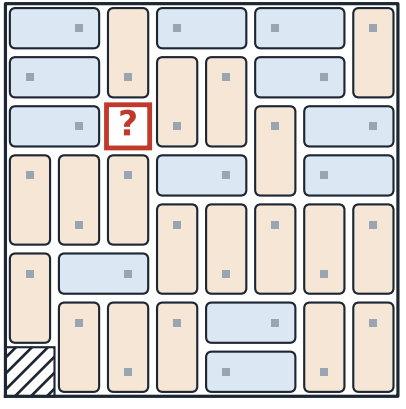
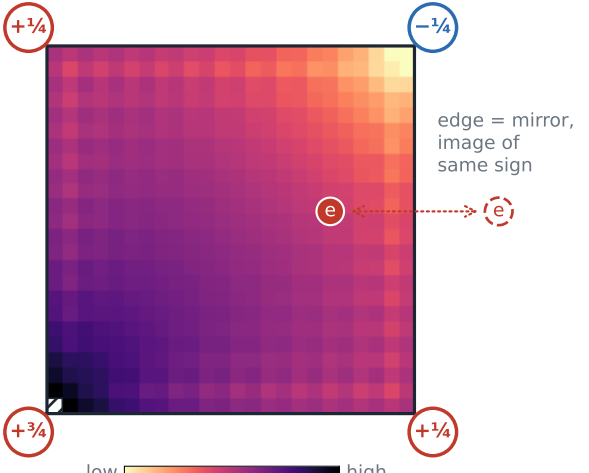
(a) The question

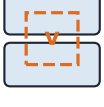


Hatched corner removed: one more white than black cell, so one cell must stay uncovered. Where does it sit?

(b) The answer: two-dimensional electrostatics

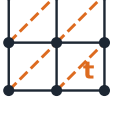


(c) What controls it



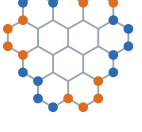
Stiffness g (dimer interactions)

charges fixed, coupling $\propto g$: every exponent rescales by $2g$ (Sec. IV)



Bipartiteness (diagonal bonds t)

no height field: the force is screened beyond $\xi \sim 1/t$ (Sec. VI)



Lattice (honeycomb)

corner charge read from the boundary height, shifted by $\pm\frac{1}{4}$ by edge class (Sec. V)